

LINUX: QT CREATOR

Uses compiler that's already on your system

RECOMMENDED

Qt Creator on Linux

Free, cross-platform, and reads the same `CMakeLists.txt` every lecture in this course ships with. Install Qt and Qt Creator using the [Qt Online Installer](#).

THE DEFAULT KIT

Qt Creator will pick your system compiler

Linux will almost always already have a C++ compiler installed system-wide. If yours doesn't yet, install one with your distro's package manager. Qt Creator will detect it automatically and offer a **Kit** that uses it.

THE CATCH

That default compiler might be old

Your distro's system GCC is whatever version shipped when your OS was released or last updated - not necessarily the latest one. This course is written against **C++23**, which needs a fairly recent compiler.

A system GCC that's a few years old may not build every example in this course - that's not a mistake on your part, it's just what "the default compiler" means.

CHECKING YOUR VERSION

Check before you assume

```
g++ --version
```

If your version is less than 14, you may need to install a newer compiler.

But don't panic - in a later lecture I will show you how to use **Docker** to get a modern GCC or Clang without touching anything already installed on your system.

OPENING THIS LECTURE

Building this lecture's program

File -> Open File or Project, select a lecture's `CMakeLists.txt`, confirm a Kit, then **Configure Project**. Build and run `rooster` the same way you would any Qt Creator project.